E3 Reading – Exam Prep Lesson 9: Synonyms, opposites and word families – Handouts

Handout 9A: Synonym cards

Cut up for Activity 1.

start	begin	shop	store
old	elderly	very tired	exhausted
happy	pleased	short	brief
not sure	doubtful	loud	noisy

My synonym pairs

Word	Same meaning

Handout 9B: Shopping Without the Noise

1 Supermarkets are usually loud, bright and crowded. For some customers this is exhausting. Now a number of London stores offer a ‘quiet hour’ once a week.

2 During the quiet hour, the store turns off the music and makes the lights dim. Staff do not use the loudspeaker, and they stop filling the shelves. The tills make no beeping sounds.

3 The idea began for shoppers with autism, who often find noise painful. However, managers soon noticed that other people liked it too. Elderly customers said they felt calmer. Parents with babies said the visit was easier.

4 Peter Lowe manages a store in Stratford. At first he was doubtful. “I thought we would lose money,” he says. “In fact, the quiet hour is now one of our busiest times.”

5 Not everybody is pleased. Some shoppers complain that the store is too dark to read the labels. Others say one hour a week is too brief.

6 Peter’s store holds its quiet hour on Tuesdays from 9am to 10am. He hopes to add a second session at the weekend.

Handout 9C: Questions on Shopping Without the Noise

Name: _____ Date: _____

Section A.

1. In paragraph 1, 'exhausting' means: Circle A, B, C or D.

- A. very tiring
- B. very cheap
- C. exciting
- D. boring

2. In paragraph 2, 'dim' means bright. Is this true or false? Tick the box.

True ☐ False ☐

3. In paragraph 3, 'elderly' customers are: Circle A, B, C or D.

- A. new
- B. old
- C. rich
- D. young

4. In paragraph 4, 'doubtful' means: Circle A, B, C or D.

- A. not sure
- B. very happy
- C. angry
- D. ready

5. 'Not everybody is pleased' means that some people are: Circle A, B, C or D.

- A. late
- B. unhappy
- C. tired
- D. quiet

6. In paragraph 5, 'brief' means long. Is this true or false? Tick the box.

True ☐ False ☐

7. In paragraph 6, 'session' means: Circle A, B, C or D.

- A. a shop
- B. a manager
- C. a period of time
- D. a price

8. Find a word in the text.

- A word in paragraph 2 that means 'shop': _____
- A word in paragraph 3 that means 'started': _____
- A word in paragraph 5 that means 'say they are not happy': _____

Section B. Change the word in brackets to fit the sentence.

1. Peter is a _____ (manage) in Stratford.
2. The supermarket is very _____ (noise) on Saturdays.
3. Some _____ (shop) do not like the dark.
4. One woman made a _____ (complain) about the lights.
5. The staff speak _____ (quiet) during the hour.